

CURRICULUM.md — the course arc

A masters-cohort course (8–12 weeks works; the arc below is written for 10) around the shared mage: **sci-fi casting forward** → **poems compressing into human-readable** → **formal papers**, each week feeding the machine the room trains. The cohort ends holding its own evaluation harness, three bound books, and the provenance chain (artifact/PROVENANCE.md).

The weekly shape (every week, after week 1)

1. **Steward handover** — outgoing steward's `corpus_pack --verify` green in front of the room; incoming steward takes the key (mage/STEWARD.md).
2. **Ingest** — the week's audio notes and drafts through `ingest/transcribe.mjs` → consent lines → corpus (INGEST.md).
3. **Express** — participants work their triptychs with the mage as mirror (never as grader — FACILITATOR.md rule 4).
4. **The babblefish round** — submitted triptychs face the blind gate (`node driver/run_round.mjs --model <mage> --run w<N> --tritych <dir>`). The probe form is drawn where no one can tune it: *the tongue you didn't polish is the lesson*.
5. **Fold** — the keystone pair folds VALIDATED levers (frontier first, prose second); the steward folds the week's corpus; both hashes read aloud.
6. **Seal** — the week closes with the group seal (CEREMONY.md §7).

The arc

weeks	movement	what happens
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1	The Rite	full ceremony (CEREMONY.md); the room reads the seed triptych + register; everyone's first expression = their Traveler key
2–3	Casting forward	sci-fi entry: each participant drafts a narrative carrying claims they choose; first live rounds; lexicon workshop — the cohort proposes its first new claims to the keystone
4–5	Compressing	poem entry: the scarcest tongue (frontier OT-1); pairs swap — compress <i>each other's</i> narrative; Mentor rungs open (blind-assayer service)
6–7	Formalizing	paper entry: formal renderings; citations discipline; triptychs complete and face the census
8	The turn: own the evaluation	the cohort re-fits the five answers (metric · gate · hard constraint · canary · Gap recipe) in a keystone session — the course's stated goal: they graduate owning the examiner, not just passing it. Register amendments folded; conform must stay green before and after (Go)
9	Binding	<code>bind_book.mjs</code> — the Book of Poems, the Collected Papers, the Story Anthology; provenance page checked by a stranger (someone outside the cohort replays the chain)
10	The Oasis leg	consented pages spooled and carried to the federation (OASIS_LOOP.md); closing seal; the mage's flight case shuts on a corpus that is <i>them</i>

The trust ladder → mechanics

Rungs are earned by expressed understanding (never by credential — C5), and audited by the enumerable checklist in UNDERSTANDING_KEY.md:

rung	earned by
Traveler	consented + first expression admitted (week 1 seal)

Contributor	at least one form carrying ≥ 1 claim through the gate
Author	a full triptych VALIDATED by the census
Mentor	serving as blind assayer for another's triptych (the human seat of the prover — reads the probe form cold, never the canon)
Fellow	proposing a claim the keystone accepts into the register — their words become part of what every later triptych is measured against

Steward rotation is orthogonal to the ladder: every student takes exactly one week holding the mage's training, whatever their rung — the chain in `mage/steward_log.md` must end the course with every name in it.

Assessment posture (for the university partner)

The harness produces the artefacts a program can assess — validated triptychs, fold history, the amended register — but the *grading* of record stays the institution's own act. The workshop's gate answers "does the understanding survive translation?", which is a different and complementary question to "what mark does this earn?" (UNIVERSITY_ONEPAGER.md).